



ENG508

Final-Term (☆☆☆☆☆☆)

ABSTRACT

This comprehensive collection of notes is accurately crafted to empower students to excel academically, ensuring they achieve a minimum of 80% marks in their examinations. The content is organized with clarity and precision, focusing on key concepts, critical analyses, and practical applications tailored to the syllabus. These notes serve as a reliable resource for both thorough preparation and last-minute revision. Designed to inspire confidence and mastery, this guide is an essential tool for students striving for academic excellence.

Maha Malik

Semantics and Pragmatics

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1. Define Ambiguity

Ambiguity occurs when a word or sentence has **more than one interpretation**.

2. Structural vs Lexical Ambiguity

- **Structural:** ambiguity due to sentence structure
 - **Lexical:** ambiguity due to multiple word meanings
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3. Conceptual vs Procedural Meaning

- **Conceptual:** gives core meaning
 - **Procedural:** guides interpretation in discourse
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4. Difficulties in Word-to-Word Translation

Lack of exact equivalents, cultural differences, and idiomatic expressions.

5. Intertextual Model

Texts gain meaning through **connections with other texts** and prior knowledge.

6. Use of Machine Language in Linguistics

Helps in **text analysis, translation, speech recognition**, and AI.

7. Anglo-Saxon Aim in Writing

Focuses on **clarity, directness, and practicality**.

8. Expressive Speech Acts

Express speaker's feelings (e.g., thanking, apologizing).

9. Declarations

Speech acts that **change institutional reality** (e.g., declaring marriage).

10. Training of ELT Outside Classroom

Focuses on workplace skills, interviews, pragmatics, and real-life communication.

11. Action Theory

Communication is a **joint activity** based on shared background knowledge.

12. Transcription of Conversation

Uses **orthographic transcription** showing pauses, fillers, overlaps.

13. Presupposition

Background assumptions a speaker assumes before speaking.

14. Entailment

Logical meaning that **necessarily follows** from a sentence.

15. Role of Computer in Linguistics

Supports **CALL, corpus linguistics, dictionary making, AI, and speech recognition.**

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16. Adjacency Pairs

Paired utterances like **question–answer**, greeting–greeting.

17. Types of Sequences

Pre-sequences, insertion sequences, opening and closing sequences.

18. Training in Pragmatics Outside Classroom

Teachers raise awareness and guide learners toward pragmatic competence.

19. Conditions for Promise

Event won't happen automatically and will benefit the hearer.

20. Conditions for Warning

Speaker believes event will occur and it will be harmful.

21. Macro Functions of Language

- **Transactional:** information
 - **Interactional:** social relations
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22. Solidarity and Politeness

Uses closeness, shared language, nicknames, and inclusive terms.

23. Driving Force Behind Grice's Work

Difference between **what is said** and **what is meant**.

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24. Western Perspective on Gender

Men dominate mixed talk; women use specific speech patterns.

25. Experimental Pragmatics

Uses **online (eye-tracking)** and **offline** experimental methods.

26. Why Pragmatics Is Less Explored in CL

Difficult to model **context, world knowledge, and speaker beliefs**.

27. Degree of Formality in Politeness

Lower-status speakers use more politeness and indirectness.

28. Fragment

Incomplete sentence conveying complete meaning (e.g., “Five.”).

29. Ordered Entailment

Speaker highlights one logical entailment as most important.

30. Turn-Taking

Rules for managing who speaks and when in conversation.

31. Can Pragmatic Competence Be Taught?

Yes, through instruction and awareness-raising in classrooms.

32. Language, Power & Political Discourse

Language constructs reality and maintains power (CDA).

33. Generalized vs Scalar vs Particularized Implicature

- **Generalized:** no special context
 - **Scalar:** based on scales (some → not all)
 - **Particularized:** context-dependent
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34. Components of Sociopragmatics

Word choice, prosody, tone, grammar, interactional routines.

35. Role of Corpora in Dictionary Making

Shows real usage, collocations, and frequency patterns.

36. M-Principle

Marked expressions indicate marked situations.

37. Face-Saving Act

Reduces threat to speaker or hearer's face.

38. Speech Acts and Culture

Speech acts vary across cultures and may cause misunderstanding.

39. Online vs Offline Measures

- **Online:** eye-tracking, reaction time
 - **Offline:** judgment tasks
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40. Reasons ELT Goals Changed

English not owned by natives, global use, focus on communication.

41. Communicative Competence

Ability to use language **appropriately and effectively** in context.

42. Direct vs Indirect Speech Acts

- **Direct:** form = function
 - **Indirect:** form ≠ function
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43. Deictic Reference

Meaning depends on **context (speaker, time, place)**.

44. Non-Western Gender Perspective

Honorifics and gender-neutral features common in Asian cultures.

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Compilation